W. Scott Langford

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Interests

Research: Local Government and Nonprofit Finance; Economic Resilience; Economic Development
Teaching: Policy Analysis and Program Evaluation; Quantitative Methods; Public and Nonprofit Finance and Budgeting

Employment

Texas State University - Department of Political Science 2025 - Present
Assistant Professor of Public Administration

Arizona State University - School of Public Affairs 2022 - 2025
Post-Doctoral Research Fellow

Education

The University of North Carolina - Chapel Hill 2022
Doctor of Philosophy in Public Policy

- *Dissertation:* Three Essays on Private Firms Under Duress Considering Local Context: How Financial Institutions and Opioid Use Affect Firms
- *Advisor:* Maryann P. Feldman

The University of North Carolina - Chapel Hill 2016
Master of Science in Biochemistry and Biophysics

The University of North Carolina - Wilmington 2012
Bachelor of Science in Chemistry

Refereed Journal Articles

10. Heinzel, C, **Langford, WS**, Peters, V, Sanders, M. Young and Small Firms and Resilience to Extreme Weather Events. *Journal of Business Venturing Insights* [Citation Impact: 4.0][1] (2025)
Policy Brief: Institut für Mittelstandsforschung (Bonn, Germany)

9. **Langford, WS**, Feldman, MP. We're Not in Dreamland Anymore: The Consequences of Community Opioid Use on Local Industrial Composition. *Journal of Regional Science* [Citation Impact: 2.5] (2024)

8. **Langford, WS**, Thomas, HW, Feldman, MP. Banking for the Other Half: The Factors That Explain Banking Desert Formation. *Economic Development Quarterly* [Citation Impact: 0.9] (2023)

7. Gitterman, D, Hay Jr., WW, **Langford, WS**. The NIH Childhood Adversity Portfolio: Unmet Needs, Emerging Challenges. *Pediatric Research* [Citation Impact: 2.6] (2023)

6. **Langford, WS**, Feldman, MP. We Miss You George Bailey: The Effect of Local Banking Conditions on the County-Level Timing of the Great Recession. *Regional Studies* [Citation Impact: 5.7] (2022)

5. Gitterman, D, **Langford, WS**, Hay Jr., WW. Making the Case for Pediatric Research: A Life-Cycle Approach and The Return on Investment. *Pediatric Research* [Citation Impact: 2.6] (2022)

4. Graddy-Reed, A, Feldman, MP, Bercovitz, J, **Langford, WS**. The Distribution of Indirect Cost Recovery in Academic Research. *Science and Public Policy* [Citation Impact: 3.1] (2021)

3. Nager, AB, Lowe Reed, AS, **Langford, WS**. Catching the Whale: A Comparison of Place Promotion Strategies Through the Lens of Amazon HQ2. *Geography Compass* [Citation Impact: 3.1] (2019)

2. Gitterman, DP, **Langford, WS**, Hay Jr., WW. The Uncertain Fate of the National Institutes of Health (NIH) Pediatric Research Portfolio. *Pediatric Research* [Citation Impact: 2.6] (2018)

1. Gitterman, DP, **Langford, WS**, Hay Jr., WW. The Fragile State of the National Institutes of Health Pediatric Research Portfolio, 1992-2015. *JAMA Pediatrics* [Citation Impact: 6.8] (2018)

[1] Bracketed "Citation Impact" values are each journal's two-year mean citedness (average citations per recent article), sourced from OpenAlex (openalex.org).

Prior Research (Chemistry)

1. Halkides, CJ, **Langford, WS**, Kish, WS, Johnson, NP, Lookadoo, DB, Hey, B, Jansen, D, Hifko, N. Synthesis of Proposed Inhibitors of the Enzyme Aspartate-Beta-Semialdehyde Dehydrogenase. *Journal of Undergraduate Chemistry Research* (2018)

Working Papers

4. **Langford, WS**, Roman, R, Berger, AN, Feldman, MP. "Let Us Put Our Moneys Together:" Minority-Owned Banks and Resilience to Crises. *SSRN Working Paper #4231594 — Resubmitted after Revise and Resubmit*
Media Coverage: Wall Street Journal

3. Chaudhry, H, Hines, R, **Langford, WS**, Grandage, AJ, Waddell, M. Do Federal Hazard Mitigation Assistance Grants Pay Off? An Empirical Analysis of Cost-Effectiveness.
Available Upon Request — Revise and Resubmit

2. Peters, V, **Langford, WS**, Sanders, M, Feldman, MP. Local Finance and Economic Resilience During Extreme Weather Events. *SSRN Working Paper #4868821 — Under Review*

1. **Langford, WS**, Steuart, SR. Extreme Weather Events Disrupt the Flow of Opioids and OUD Medications.
Available Upon Request — Under Review

Works in Progress

12. **Langford, WS**. The Effect of Extreme Weather Events on Local Tax Revenue and Reserves.

11. **Langford, WS**, Chen, X. The Effect of Extreme Weather Events on Nonprofit Survival.

10. **Langford, WS**, Hines, R, Grandage, AJ, Chaudhry, H, Waddell, M. Do Hazard Mitigation Grants Pay Off? From Identification to Policy.

9. Chaudhry, H, Grandage, AJ, Hines, R, **Langford, WS**, Waddell, M. Cost-Savings in Hazard Mitigation: The Impact of Program Type.

8. **Langford, WS**. Employment Outcomes in the Public Administration Academic Job Market.

7. **Langford, WS**, Singla, AG. The Effect of Access to Local Finance on Local Government Finance.

6. Kattikatt, C, Rangarajan, N, **Langford, WS**. Local Government and Data.

5. **Langford, WS**, Peters, V, Sanders, M. Extreme Weather and Employment: Differential Effects Across Race and Ethnicity.

4. Petach, L, **Langford, WS**. Banking Deregulation and Carbon Emissions: Evidence from US States.

3. **Langford, WS**. Extracting Local Government Financial Data with Large Language Models.

2. **Langford, WS**, Feldman, MP. Minority-Owned Bank Failures and Their Local Economic Consequences.

1. Deming, K, **Langford, WS**. Discontinuities in the PPP Fee Structure.

Other Writing

3. Gitterman, D, Hay Jr., WW, **Langford, WS**. The National Institute of Health and Responding to New Forms of Childhood Adversity. *Children's Health Care* [Citation Impact: 0.8] (2022)

2. Feldman, MP, Bailey, AN, Lowe Reed, AS, **Langford, WS**. Combine Water, Grain, Hops, Yeast and Get – Jobs. *News and Observer (Raleigh, NC)* (2019)

1. Feldman, MP, **Langford, WS**. Knowledge Spillovers Informed by Network Theory and Social Network Analysis. *Handbook of Regional Science.* (ed) Fischer, M, Capello, R. (2019)

Research Funding

Reading the Public Record:
A Live, Public Pipeline for Government and Nonprofit Data
Texas State Research Enhancement Program ($12,000) — Under Review 2026

We're Not in Dreamland Anymore:
How Regional Opioid Use Rates Affect Industrial Composition
Hammer Fund Travel Award (NARSC Annual Research Conference, $750) 2021
Graduate Student Transportation Grant (NARSC Annual Research Conference, $400)

Small Business Activity in Banking Deserts
Kenan Institute Frontiers of Entrepreneurship Small Grant ($10,000) 2018

The Snowball Effect of Federal Research Funding
Hammer Fund Travel Award (APPAM Annual Research Conference, $500) 2018

Applied Research & Consulting

Town of Clayton Economic Mobility Study
Lookout Analytics; Role: Consultant; Lead Consultant: Jen Yip; Total Project $37,346 2026

Cost-Benefit Analysis for Clayton, NC
Lookout Analytics; Role: Lead Consultant; In Progress; $65,000 2025

Teaching Experience

Instructor *(online unless marked in person)*
Analytical Techniques (Texas State; Undergrad; in person; PA 3311 / PS 3315) Link to Syllabus 2025 – 2026
Public Policy Process (Texas State; Undergrad; writing intensive; PA 3350) Link to Syllabus Fall 2026
Independent Study: Quantitative Methods for Nonprofit Research (Texas State; MPA; PA 5388) Fall 2026
Strategic Planning (Texas State; CPM Program; in person) Summer 2026
Emergency Management (Texas State; CPM Program; in person) Fall 2025
Comparative Public Administration (Texas State; Undergrad) Link to Syllabus Fall 2025
Public Finance Administration (Texas State; MPA) Link to Syllabus Fall 2025
Statistics for Social and Criminological Research (West Texas A&M; MPA) Link to Syllabus Spring 2025
Quantitative Methods (UNC Pembroke; MPA) Link to Syllabus Fall 2024
Applied Econometrics (Arizona State; MPA, MPP, PhD) Spring 2023 and 2024
Innovative Solutions to the Social and Economic
Problems Exposed by the COVID-19 Epidemic (UNC Chapel Hill; Undergrad) - Link to Syllabus Spring 2021
The Politics of Public Policy (UNC Chapel Hill; Undergrad) - Link to Syllabus Summer 2020

Open-Access Teaching Materials
Analytical Techniques for Public Administration (PA 3311 textbook; open-access) Link to Textbook 2025 – Present

Invited Lecturer
Innovation, Science, and Public Policy Fall 2021 and Spring 2019
Private Enterprise and the Public Good Spring 2020
Innovation, Entrepreneurship, and Economic Growth Spring 2020

Graduate Research Consultant
State and Local Politics Spring 2022
Innovation, Science and Public Policy Spring 2019

Teaching Assistant
The Politics of Public Policy Spring 2022, Spring and Fall 2017

Quantitative Methods for Public Policy Fall 2021
Advanced Panel Data Methodology Fall 2020
Justice in Public Policy Spring 2018

Pedagogical Training

Texas State University
Teaching Online at Texas State Fall 2025

UNC-Chapel Hill
Course Design Institute - Center for Faculty Excellence Fall 2019

Invited Talks

Economic Resilience
Texas State University ICMA Student Chapter 2025

Conference Presentations

Do Hazard Mitigation Grants Pay Off? From Identification to Policy
ABFM Annual Research Conference 2026

Extreme Weather Events and Mitigation Strategies: County-Level Evidence
ABFM Annual Research Conference 2024
SouthEastern Conference For Public Administration

Extreme Weather and Employment: Differential Effects Across Race and Ethnicity
APPAM Annual Research Conference - Panel Organizer 2024
Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day

How Entrepreneurship Strengthens Resilience Through Extreme Weather Events
APPAM Annual Research Conference - Panel Organizer 2024

"Let Us Put Our Moneys Together:"
Minority-Owned Banks and Resilience to Crises
American Economic Association Annual Meeting 2024
APPAM Annual Research Conference - Panel Organizer 2023
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting - Panel Organizer
ABFM Annual Research Conference
SouthEastern Conference For Public Administration
Eastern Finance Association
Midwest Finance Association
Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day 2022
FDIC Bank Research Conference
Community Banking Research Conference
NARSC Annual Research Conference

Local Finance and Economic Resilience During Extreme Weather Events
Presented as "George Bailey Meets the Tempestates."
APPAM Annual Research Conference 2023

We're Not in Dreamland Anymore:
How Regional Opioid Use Rates Affect Industrial Composition
ABFM Annual Research Conference 2021
APPAM Annual Research Conference - Panel Organizer
Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day

CEnSE Urban and Regional Economics Workshop[2]
DRUID Industry and Innovation Conference[3]
NARSC Annual Research Conference
SEA Annual Meeting - Panel Organizer
SouthEastern Conference For Public Administration

We Miss You George Bailey: The Effect of Local Banking Conditions on the County-Level Timing of the Great Recession 2020
Southern Regional Science Association[4]

The Snowball Effect of Federal Research Funding 2018
APPAM Annual Research Conference

Professional Affiliations

- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (*APPAM*)
- American Society for Public Administration (*ASPA*)
- Association for Budgeting and Financial Management (*ABFM*)

Professional Experience

Co-Principal Investigator | *US Census Bureau - Federal Statistical Research Data Center* 2022-2026
- Title: The Roles of the Opioid and COVID Crises in Entrepreneurship and Innovation
- Co-Principal Investigator: Maryann P. Feldman
- This project uses restricted use Census Bureau data to compare measures of entrepreneurial activity and observe how opioid use has impacted entrepreneurial activity.
- Special Sworn Status, US Census Bureau (2023-2026)

Research Associate | *CREATE-Kenan Institute of Private Enterprise* 2019-2022

Research Assistant | *North Carolina Entrepreneurship Data Initiative* 2020
- Principal Investigator: Maryann P. Feldman
- This project measured entrepreneurial activity across North Carolina and developed novel entrepreneurship metrics. My role was to collect data via publicly available datasets and primary survey data collection.

Research Assistant | *Early Stage Evaluation of the Kauffman Foundation's ESHIP Communities Project* 2018–2019
- Principal Investigator: Maryann P. Feldman
- This project evaluated a program aiming to increase entrepreneurial activity in Kansas City. My role was to collect data via publicly available datasets and primary survey data collection.

Research Assistant | *Examining the US Pediatric Research Portfolio* 2016-2018, 2022
- Principal Investigator: Daniel P. Gitterman
- The purpose of this project was to prepare manuscripts reviewing the current state of the NIH pediatric research portfolio. My role was to collect and analyze publicly available data and assist in manuscript preparation.

Leadership Experience, Awards, and Professional Service

Founder/Administrator | *Academic Job Market Report - public dashboard of open faculty positions* 2026-Present
Vice President | *CENTEX Chapter, American Society for Public Administration (ASPA)* 2026-Present
Committee Member | *Ph.D. in Public Administration Exploratory Committee, Texas State University* 2026
Discussant | *APPAM Annual Research Conference* 2025
Selection Panelist | *APPAM Equity and Inclusion Fellowship* 2025
Associate Editor | *Academy of Management (AoM) Annual Meeting - TIM Division* 2021
Elected Member | *Frank Porter Graham Honor Society, UNC* 2021

[2]Declined or cancelled due to COVID-19 restrictions.
[3]Declined or cancelled due to COVID-19 restrictions.
[4]Declined or cancelled due to COVID-19 restrictions.

Emerging Scholar | *Community Banking in the 21st Century Research Conference* 2020
Co-Senator, Public Policy | *Graduate and Professional Student Federation (GPSF), UNC* 2019-2021
Finance Committee Member | *GPSF* 2020-2021
Vice President – Internal Affairs | *Science Policy and Advocacy Group, UNC* 2015-2016
Ambassador | *DNA Day NC* 2015-2016
Eagle Scout Award | *Boy Scouts of America* 2006

Advising and Mentorship

Brianna Mendez | *Applied Research Project Committee - Texas State University* 2026-present
Christina Kattikatt | *Current: MPA Student - Texas State University* 2025-present
Dustin Miller | *Assistant City Manager, Pampa, TX* | *MPA Student - West Texas A&M University* 2025
Khushi Wadhwani | *Current: Undergraduate Student - Arizona State University* 2024-2025
Cody Taylor | *Assistant Professor - Appalachian State University* 2023-2025
Harrison Thomas | *Law Student - UT Knoxville* 2020-2023

Referee Experience

Journals: Climate Resilience & Sustainability; Public Budgeting & Finance; Public Management Review; Nature Energy; Research Policy; Southern Economic Journal; Papers in Regional Science; Journal of Urban Affairs; Journal of Small Business Strategy; Journal of Infrastructure, Policy and Development
Conferences: AoM Annual Meeting (2020-2023)
Book manuscripts: Cambridge University Press

Technical Programs

Stata, R, Python, SQL, Git, LaTeX, ArcGIS, Tableau, Qualtrics
Methods: applied econometrics; building research datasets from unstructured public documents, including large-language-model extraction